

James Whitford

Forward Deployed Engineer & AI Workflow Specialist

james.whitford0@gmail.com Pretoria, South Africa LinkedIn GitHub Portfolio

SKILLS

AI Agents & Workflows

Claude Code, Multi-agent systems, MCP servers, RAG pipelines, Subagent orchestration, Prompt engineering, Agent evaluation frameworks, n8n, Zapier, Letta

Frontend Development

HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, TypeScript, Next.js, HTMx

Backend Development

Node.js, Express.js, Python, RESTful APIs, OAuth, API integration

Databases

MongoDB, MySQL, Redis, Supabase, Firebase

Technical Communication

API documentation, Integration guides, Agent pattern documentation, SDK migration docs, AX audits, Developer tutorials

Dev Tools

Git, Vercel, Docker, Playwright, Docusaurus

CERTIFICATIONS

IBM Generative AI for Software

Developers

IBM / Coursera

Meta Frontend Developer

Meta / Coursera

Google UX Design Certification

Google

Software Engineering Bootcamp

HyperionDev

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts

Philosophy and Politics

University of South Africa

PROFILE

I build production AI systems and document them from the inside. For four years at Ritza, I have embedded with engineering teams at companies like Letta, Sentry, Bryntum, and Sourcegraph, scoped their actual workflows, built working integrations, and shipped the documentation that explains how they work.

My daily toolkit is Claude Code, MCP servers, multi-agent pipelines, RAG systems, and automation tools like n8n. I design and run agentic research workflows, evaluate emerging AI tooling against production criteria, and build proof-of-concept systems that go directly into published guides and client deliverables.

I hold a degree in Philosophy and Politics. That background shapes how I work: I think at the system level, communicate clearly across technical and non-technical audiences, and move fast in ambiguous environments where requirements are still being discovered.

EXPERIENCE

Forward Deployed Engineer & Technical Writer

2022 - present

(Contract)

Ritza · Remote (contract)

- Embedded with engineering and product teams at Letta, Sentry, Bryntum, Sourcegraph, Code Capsules, Replit, Release, Cerebrum, and Speakeasy to scope requirements, build production integrations, and ship documentation.
- Built and deployed MCP servers for client platforms, evaluated MCP tooling against production criteria, and published comparative AX (Agent Experience) audits covering discoverability, onboarding, integration, and agent tooling stages.
- Designed and operated multi-agent research pipelines using Claude Code with custom subagents, RAG systems built from scraped documentation, and structured evaluation frameworks to produce verifiable, data-backed content.
- Authored 36+ documents for Letta's official docs site, including multi-agent pattern guides (supervisor-worker, parallel execution, consensus voting, hierarchical teams), SDK migration documentation, and integration tutorials with Supabase, n8n, and Zapier.
- Built a meeting-to-task automation pipeline that transcribed Skype meeting recordings, parsed action items per participant, and pushed structured to-dos into project management tooling.
- Built VirtualFit, a Telegram bot using the Black Forest Labs FLUX.2 API for photorealistic outfit try-ons, shipped as a production guide with full tutorial and GitHub repo.

- Developed an AI email assistant integrating Letta (stateful agent memory), n8n (workflow automation), and Resend (transactional email), published as an end-to-end production tutorial.
- Performed technical QA on other writers' code and documentation: cloned repos, followed tutorials end-to-end, verified outputs, corrected broken code, and held content to client publication standards.
- Multiple pieces have reached the Hacker News front page, including the Cerebrum/vLLM migration guide, the Sourcegraph Zig article, and pieces on tldraw and GLM, and documentation and guides consistently rank #1 in search results.

Code Reviewer

2022-01 - 2022-04

CoGrammar · Remote

- Assessed code submissions in Python, Java, SQL, HTML, CSS, and JavaScript against accuracy, style, efficiency, and documentation standards.
- Delivered structured, educational feedback to help developers improve their skills.

Operations Manager

2023-05 - 2025-02

Equleni Guest Farm · Sedgefield, South Africa

- Managed team responsible for maintenance, guest communications, accounts, design, and overall guest experience.
- Redesigned operational workflows and executed branding initiatives that contributed to consistent five-star reviews.

English Second Language Teacher

2021-04 - 2022-01

Whales English · Remote

- Taught immersive English lessons to students aged 3-18 using National Geographic and Oxford curricula.

FEATURED PROJECTS

Letta Multi-Agent Pattern Guides

AI/ML

Authored 5 production multi-agent architecture guides covering supervisor-worker, parallel execution, producer-reviewer, round-robin, and hierarchical teams patterns.

[Link](#)

Migrate from OpenAI to Cerebrum with vLLM

AI/ML

One of several pieces to reach the Hacker News front page.

[Link](#)

Smarter Debugging with Sentry MCP for Cursor

AI/ML

MCP server integration guide published on the official Sentry blog.

[Link](#)

VirtualFit Telegram Bot

Full-Stack

Production Telegram bot using Black Forest Labs FLUX.2 API for photorealistic outfit try-ons.

[Link](#)

Can My AI Agent Order Me a Burger With Mr D?

AI/ML

Reverse-engineered a private delivery API and built an MCP server so an agent can order end to end.

[Link](#)

Which Payment Processor Do AI Agents Recommend?

AI/ML

Agent experience comparison of Yoco, PayFast, and Paystack, tested from primary sources.

[Link](#)